

EDM 101 – Ethics and Patients' Rights in Dental Medicine

Lecture 4

Dentists and Society

Dr. Barzi Barzan M Fadhil

BDS, MSc, Advanced Aesthetic Restorative Dentistry



barzi.barzan@auis.edu.krd



Drbarzibarzan



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

This classes learning outcomes

By the end of this lecture you are able to

- Explain the ethical relationship between dentists and society.
- Recognize ethical conflicts between individual patient care and social responsibility.
- Describe dentists' roles in public health and global health.



Why Does Society Matter in Dentistry?

Dentistry is not only individual care:

- A. Social responsibility
- B. Public trust
- C. Professional privilege
- D. Community impact



Professionalism and Society

Dentistry involves:

- Service to others
- Moral responsibility
- Specialized knowledge
- Professional autonomy



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Why Society Grants Privileges;

Society allows dentists:

- Self-regulation
- Respect and professional status
- Patient trust
- Financial independence

In return:

- Ethical conduct
- Competence
- Public protection (Protect patient welfare)



Dentist's Roles in Society

Dentists contribute through:

- A. Public health promotion
- B. Health education
- C. Environmental awareness
- D. Legal/forensic roles
- E. Protecting patients from harm



Dual Loyalty

Dentist Loyalty to

1. Individual Patient
2. Society.



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Examples of Dual Loyalty Conflicts

Dentists may need to report:

- A. Infectious diseases
- B. Child abuse
- C. Human rights violations



Industry and Commercial Conflicts

Dentists must critically evaluate.

- Dental products
- Pharmaceutical claims
- Manufacturer marketing



Resource Allocation

Healthcare Resources

- Time
- Equipment
- Money
- Workforce

Limited



Levels of Resource Allocations

Macro level – National decisions

Meso level – Hospital/clinic decisions

Micro level – Dentist decisions



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Ethical Allocation Approaches

Approach	Idea
Libertarian	Pay-based access
Utilitarian	Greatest benefit
Egalitarian	Equal need
Restorative	Help disadvantaged



Dentist Decisions at Micro Level

Dentists decide:

- Radiographs frequency
- Treatment complexity
- Referral necessity



Public Health Responsibilities

Public health is about improving community health.

Dentists should:

- Educate patients
- Promote prevention
- Identify social health risks



Dentist as Public Health Advocate

- Health education programs
- Reporting hazards
- Supporting prevention policies



Global Health

A. Cross-border diseases

B. Shared health challenges

C. International cooperation

As:

COVID-19, SARS



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Globalization and Dentistry

- Migration of dentists
- Refugee oral health needs
- Workforce imbalance



Ethical Responsibility in Global Workforce

FDI recommendations:

- A. Prevent exploitation
- B. Support fair recruitment
- C. Maintain workforce balance



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Case;

A dentist must report a contagious disease but patient asks for secrecy.



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Summary;

1. Dentistry operates under a social contract.
2. Dual loyalty creates ethical challenges.
3. Resource allocation requires fairness.
4. Dentists contribute to public and global health.



Thank You!



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI
زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية